



◀ HIGH-SPEED HUNTERS

The predators that roam the open ocean are equipped for covering long distances as quickly as possible. They include tuna that hunt in packs and solitary hunters like oceanic sharks and this blue marlin. They are streamlined, powerful animals, and some are able to swim at speeds of well over 50 mph (80 kph).

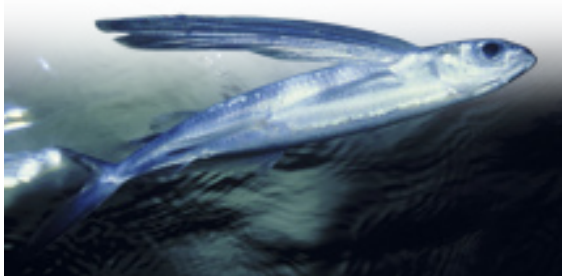


▲ BAITBALLS

Small, plankton-feeding fish travel in shoals that bunch together in dense "baitballs" when they are attacked by bigger fish, spinning and swirling to confuse their enemies. But the commotion—and the scent of blood from casualties—often attracts more predators that join the attack in a feeding frenzy.

▼ AIRBORNE FISH

Tropical flyingfish have extended fins that act as wings, enabling them to leap clear of the water and glide through the air if they are attacked. This is a good way of escaping predatory fish such as tuna, but airborne flyingfish are often targeted by oceanic frigate birds that swoop down to seize them in their bills.



► SEAMOUNT HOTSPOTS

The floor of the Pacific is dotted with extinct submarine volcanoes called seamounts. These can cause local upwelling zones as ocean currents push cold, nutrient-rich water up their slopes in eddies that swirl toward the surface. The nutrients promote the growth of plankton, which provides food for local concentrations of fish. These attract bigger fish and powerful predators such as sharks, creating wildlife hotspots in tropical deep oceans where marine life can be scarce.

